

where are the robots

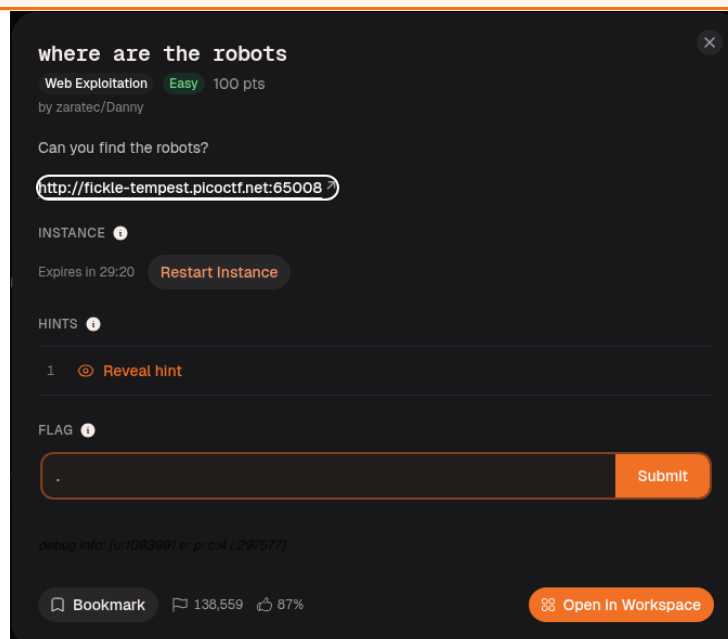
A short solve focused on the clue, the web concept, and the exact discovery path.

Challenge	where are the robots
Category	Web Exploitation - Easy - 100 pts
Core issue	Information disclosure through robots.txt

1. Reading the challenge clue

The challenge title was "where are the robots", and the hint asked: "What part of the website could tell you where the creator does not want you to look?" That wording strongly points to robots.txt.

robots.txt is a public file placed at the root of a website. It gives crawling instructions to web robots. A Disallow entry asks compliant crawlers not to visit a path, but it does not stop a human from requesting that path directly.



Screenshot 1 - Challenge prompt and hint context.

2. Checking robots.txt

I requested the standard robots file from the website root:

```
curl http://TARGET/robots.txt
```

The response was:

```
User-agent: *
Disallow: /cc6b1.html
```

User-agent: * means the rule applies to all crawlers. Disallow: /cc6b1.html reveals a page the site owner asked bots not to crawl. The important security lesson is that the path itself is now public information.

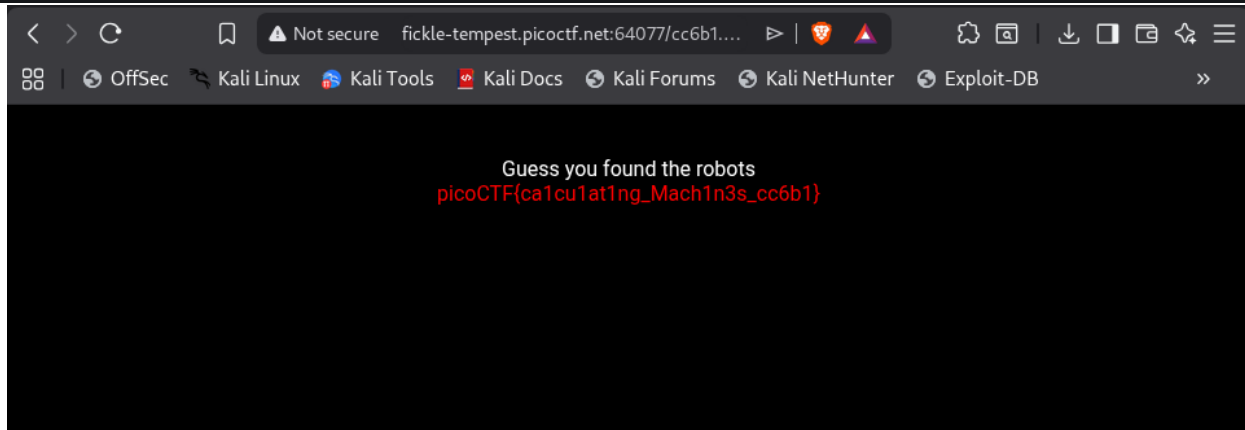
3. Visiting the disclosed path

Because robots.txt is not an access-control mechanism, I manually requested the disclosed page:

```
curl http://TARGET/cc6b1.html
```

The HTML response contained the flag directly:

```
<flag>picoCTF{calculat1ng_Mach1n3s_cc6b1}</flag>
```



Screenshot 2 - The hidden page displayed the flag in the browser.

4. Final solve path

1	Challenge title and hint mention "robots" and places the creator does not want crawled.
2	Request /robots.txt.
3	Find Disallow: /cc6b1.html.
4	Visit the disclosed path manually.
5	Read the flag from the page.

Flag

picoCTF{calculat1ng_Mach1n3s_cc6b1}

Main lesson

robots.txt is not a security control. It is meant for crawler guidance, not for hiding sensitive pages. Putting secret or sensitive routes in Disallow can actually advertise those routes to anyone who checks the file.

Useful beginner habit

During web enumeration, checking /robots.txt is a quick, low-effort step. It can reveal paths, directories, or endpoints that are worth investigating.